

ATAR Psychology

Unit 2 Test – Answer Key

QUESTION 1 (10 marks)

Sarah owns a small café in a busy part of town. She recently introduced a new rule: all employees must work 8-hour shifts, with only one short break allowed during their shift.

One of Sarah's employees, Aisha, is Muslim and requires regular prayer times throughout the day. The new rule makes it difficult for her to find time to pray.

a. Distinguish between direct and indirect discrimination (4 marks)

- Direct discrimination occurs when someone is treated less favorably because of a specific characteristic. (1)
- Indirect discrimination occurs when a rule applies to everyone but unfairly affects a particular group. (1)
- Direct discrimination is overt and explicit, while indirect discrimination can be more subtle and unintentional. (1)
- Both forms of discrimination negatively affect the target. (1)

b. Explain how Sarah's rule is an example of indirect discrimination (1 mark)

- Sarah's rule applies to all employees but disproportionately affects Aisha, because it does not accommodate her need for prayer breaks due to her religion.

When Aisha talks to Sarah, Sarah's attitude towards Aisha religion is positive; she believes that everyone has the right to their own religious beliefs. However, she still refuses to provide for Aisha's prayer breaks.

- c. Discuss how Sarah's cognitive dissonance might affect her, and possibly change her attitude if she were made aware that her rule is indirectly discriminating against Sarah. (2 marks)
- Sarah may use **rationalization** to justify her rule as necessary for keeping the cafe's productivity, even if it discriminates against Aisha. (1)
 - To reduce CD, Sarah can change her policy to allow for prayer breaks and aligning her behaviour with her beliefs (**change behaviour**) (1)

Social Identity Theory (SIT) is a theory within social psychology that explains the role of social membership in intergroup behaviour.

- d. Identify one strength and one limitation of social identity theory

Accept reasonable answers. E.g.

- One strength is that it provides a good way to understand human behaviour in group settings (e.g. favouritism)
 - One limitation is that it describes human behaviour but does not always accurately predict it
- e. Describe how Sarah's rule affect the social identity of her employees (2 marks)
- Sarah's rule unfairly divides employees, some may not feel affiliated with the group / low self-esteem in the group (1)
 - Employees may feel excluded if their religious needs are not recognized (1)
 - leading to **less social identification** (1)*
- *students must have this for full marks

QUESTION 2 (6 marks)

a) Using **one** example of each, compare dispositional and situational attributions (4 marks)

- dispositional - assigns the cause of behaviour on internal factors that are within a person's control. (1)
- one correct example of dispositional attribution (1)
- situational - assigns the cause of behavior on external factors that are outside a person's control. (1)
- one correct example of situational attribution (1)

b) Explain what is meant by fundamental attribution error (2 marks)

- When judging another person's actions, we tend to over emphasise the dispositional factors (1) and under-emphasizing situational attributions (1)

QUESTION 3 (6 marks)

Van der Meer et al. (2020) recruited participants with strong views on certain social issues to view eight headlines relevant to those issues. The headlines came from media outlets with different political orientations. Participants were asked to rate the likelihood that they would read each article. The study found that participants more often rated articles consistent with their views as ‘highly likely to read’.

a. Describe **one** source of cognitive dissonance from this study. (2 marks)

- Participants are exposed to headlines that contradict their strong views. (1)
- This creates cognitive dissonance, as the view expressed in the headline is dissonant with the participants beliefs (1)

b. Identify and explain **two** ways which the referenced cognitive dissonance can be reduced. (4 marks)

- Avoidance (1)
 - participants can withdraw from the study / avoid reading articles that contradict their views (1)
- Rationalisation (1)
 - they may rationalize their decision not to read opposing articles by reinforcing their existing beliefs (1)

QUESTION 4 (6 marks)

The Robbers Cave Experiment is a classic study in social psychology by Muzafer Sherif which investigated the cause of prejudice and the effectiveness of contact hypothesis in reducing prejudice.

- a) Identify the year in which the experiment took place (1 mark)
 - 1954
- b) Discuss the main findings in the Robbers Cave Experiment (3 marks)
 - the two groups quickly formed strong in-group identities and showed prejudice toward the out-group (In-group favoritism)
 - competition between the ingroups and outgroups led to hostility/aggression
 - Prejudice was reduced when the groups worked together on shared goals, supporting the contact hypothesis.
- c) Identify and explain **one** ethical concern with the Robbers Cave Experiment (2 marks)

Any of, with correct explanation:

- Lack of informed consent (1)
Participants were not fully aware of the true purpose of the study or the manipulation of their behavior. (1)
- Psychological harm (1)
Participants experienced intense conflict/stress/emotional distress during competitions. (1)
- Deception (1)
Participants were misled about the nature of the experiment, which involved creating artificial conflict. (1)

QUESTION 5 (8 marks)

Andrea has recently started a new job and on her first day at work she noticed that all her colleagues were much more smartly dressed than she was.

a. Is this a form of normative influence or informational influence? (1 mark)

- normative influence (1)

b. Justify your answer (3 marks)

- This is a type of conformity / is where people 'go along with' the behaviour of the group to maintain group harmony / fit in / to avoid rejection / gain approval from others (1).
- In this case, Andrea will comply publicly with the smart dress code at work (1). She will want to align with their norms to be seen as like the rest of her colleagues and not as an outsider / to fit in (1).

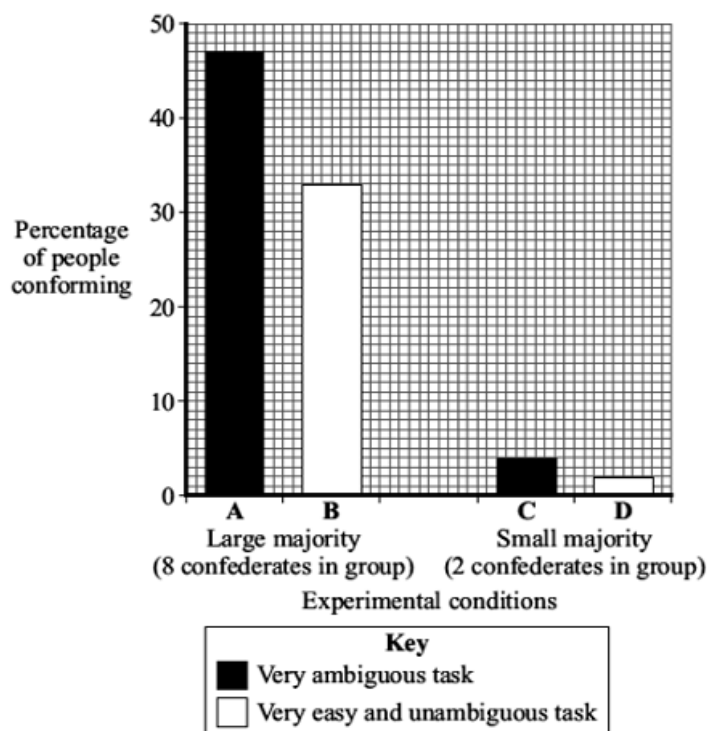
c. Compare and contrast between compliance and obedience (4 marks)

- Compliance and obedience are both forms of social influence (1 – students must have this)
- Compliance involves changing behavior due to social influence/pressure/norms/fitting in (1*) without being directly told (1)
- Obedience involves following orders from an authority figure (1*) suppressing own values / without being influenced (1)

QUESTION 6 (8 marks)

In an experiment into conformity, an experimenter varied both the number of confederates (stooges) and the ambiguity of the task. The bar chart below shows the findings.

Percentages of conformity for different tasks and size of majority



a. Describe what the bar chart shows about conformity? (4 marks)

- there are two factors that influence conformity, the ambiguity of the task (1) and the size of the majority (1)
- A large majority is most influential with an ambiguous task, but still exerts pressure even when the task is easy. (1)
- However, a small majority has less effect and the type of task does not seem to be an important variable. (1)

Most research into conformity takes place in a laboratory.

b. Outline **one** strength and **one** limitation of conducting research in a laboratory. (2 marks)

strength:

- allows the experimenter to control the variables (e.g. group size and difficulty of the task)

weakness:

- lack of ecological validity- the findings cannot be generalised to the real world (1)
- hawthorne effect- participants may act differently in a lab because they know they're being observed (1)

When you are a passenger on a train, you are much more likely to move to another seat if the ticket collector tells you to move than if another passenger tells you to do so.

c. Explain why this happens (2 marks)

- passengers obey the ticket collector because they are seen as the authority (1)

Any of:

- Power of uniform - uniform of ticket inspector reinforces their authorities role (1)
- reference to Milgram's findings (1)

QUESTION 7 (8 marks)

In 1964, Kitty Genovese was arriving home from work in the middle of the night when she was brutally stabbed to death. Multiple witnesses observed the attack but failed to intervene or call for help

- a. Identify and explain the concept that explains why you are less likely to help when other people are present (4 marks)
 - bystander effect (1)
 - in an emergency, when we believe there are other people around, we are less likely to help because we believe someone else will take responsibility. (1)
 - we may assume that other bystanders are more qualified to help, such as doctors or police, and our help is unneeded (1)
 - we may be afraid of making a mistake / giving dangerous assistance / making the situation worse (1)

The case led to increased awareness of how people behave in emergencies, prompting research into factors that contribute to inaction.

- b. Describe **two** factors that would prompt/encourage someone to take action (4 marks)
 - competence - an individual's belief in their ability to effectively handle a task (1)
 - If bystanders think they have the skills or confidence to help, like knowing first aid, - they are more likely to intervene (1)
 - Social responsibility - we are obligated to help those who need help (1)
 - If bystanders feel a moral obligation to help someone in distress, they are more likely to intervene (1)

Accept other reasonable answers, with an explanation that links to Genovese

QUESTION 8 (28 marks)

Lei is a new Year 7 student who has migrated to Perth from Taiwan.

Recently, she has noticed a lot of peer pressure to act in certain ways to fit in. At lunch, her friends tease and bully a poor boy who could not afford the school uniform, and Lei joins in because she doesn't want to be singled out. Lei doesn't actually agree with their behavior, but she finds herself going along with the group anyway.

Eventually the situation intensifies and Lei steps back. She stands by in silence, watching as her friends continue to engage in the bullying.

Discuss Lei's experiences with attitudes and conformity. Your response should include:

- Differentiation between prejudice and discrimination, justifying which term fits Lei's initial behaviour [4 marks]
- Analysis of Lei's affective, behavioural and cognitive attitude when bullying the poor boy. [6 marks]
- Discussion of environmental factors that influences bullying [3 marks]
- Explanation of why Lei conformed to bullying, despite internal disagreement. Give at least two reasons [6 marks]
- Explanation of why Lei did not speak up, and instead, stood in silence. Give at least two reasons [6 marks]
- Grammar/punctuation and use of correct psychological terminology [3 marks]

Description	Marks
Differentiation between prejudice and discrimination	
- Definition of prejudice and discrimination. - Prejudice: preconceived negative feelings about a group - Discrimination unjust treatment based on group membership	2
- Identifying discrimination fits Lei's initial behavior. - Suitable elaboration and justification	2
Analysis of Lei's affective, behavioral, and cognitive attitude	
- Definition of affective component; - Explanation of Lei's affective attitude; upset, guilt, discomfort	2
- Definition of behavioural component - Explanation of Lei's behavioral attitude; laughing or participating in teasing	2
- Definition of cognitive component - Explanation of Lei's cognitive attitude; awareness of wrongness but feeling compelled to conform	2

Discussion of environmental factors that influence bullying	
• Identification of relevant environmental factors; group dynamics, school culture	1
• Explanation of how these factors contribute to bullying behavior. Makes a connection between environment and actions (e.g., fear of exclusion) ○ Example: School culture includes the values, beliefs, and behaviors typical of the school environment. A school culture that tolerates or trivializes bullying can foster an environment where such behavior is prevalent.	2
Explanation of why Lei conformed to bullying	
• 1 mark- Stating correct factor. Any 2 of: ○ Normative Influence, Unanimity, Deindividuation, School Culture (if not already used) • 1 mark – Explanation of said factor ○ Example: Normative influence occurs when people conform to the norms of a group to gain approval/avoid rejection. • 1 mark – Application to Lei’s situation ○ Example: Being new to her school, Lei may feel more pressure to conform to her friends’ bullying behavior to fit in and gain their acceptance. This desire negatively influences her decision to participate in bullying the poor boy.	6
Explanation of why Lei did not speak up	
• 1 mark- Stating correct factor. Any 2 of: ○ Diffusion of Responsibility, Audience Inhibition, Cost–Benefit Analysis • 1 mark – Explanation of said factor ○ Example: Audience inhibition occurs when people are reluctant to act because they fear being judged by others. • 1 mark – Application to Lei’s situation ○ Example: Lei might fear that speaking out against the bullying will lead to her being ostracized or judged by her friends, prompting her to instead conform or stay silent.	6
Communication of information	
• Coherent and logically ordered paragraphs. • Appropriate psychological terminology used consistently and correctly. • Punctuation and grammar do not impede meaning.	3
TOTAL	28

NOTE: check with moderating school on alternative answers before accepting